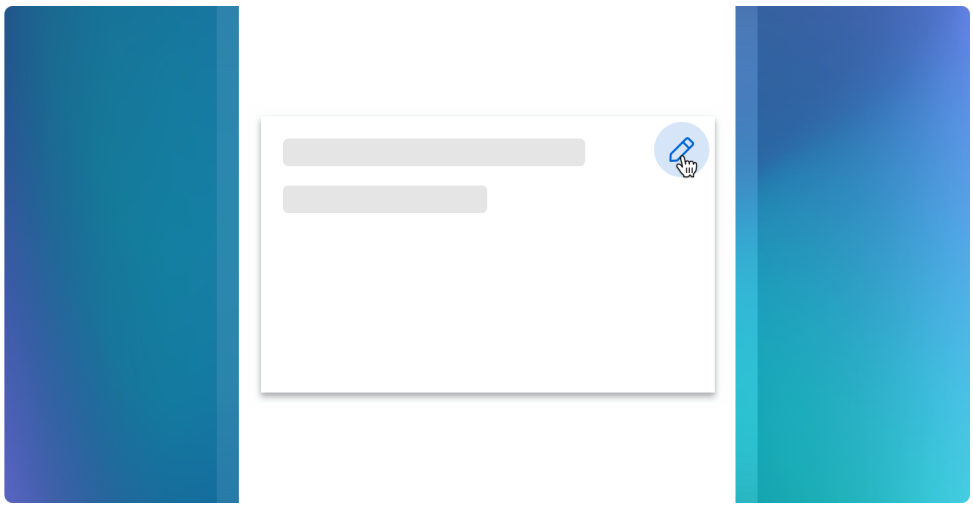
*Need help? Self-Service || Yammer || **No new spaces from Nov-23rd***

Icon Button

Created by Hillary Purssey, last modified by Genevieve Wang on 18 Feb 2021



Version

1

Availability

Web

Android

iOS

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Icon Button is a button UI element that utilises a single icon visual representation as the cue to perform the action. Icon Buttons can be used to perform inline actions within its context or perform screen navigation actions.

Useful Docs

- Key Actions with Supporting Icons

Specs

- Icon Button (Web)
- Icon Button (Android)
- Icon Button (iOS)

UI Playground

- Web Playground
- React Playground
- Android Catalogue app
- iOS Catalogue app

Usage Guidelines

- Icon Usability
  It's important to use the right icon for the right purpose. Using the same icon with a slight different meaning or functionality will hinders the ability for user to understand.
- Preventing User Errors
  Using the appropriate button style can help users to make better decisions and prevent them from making unintentional errors.

Usage Guidelines

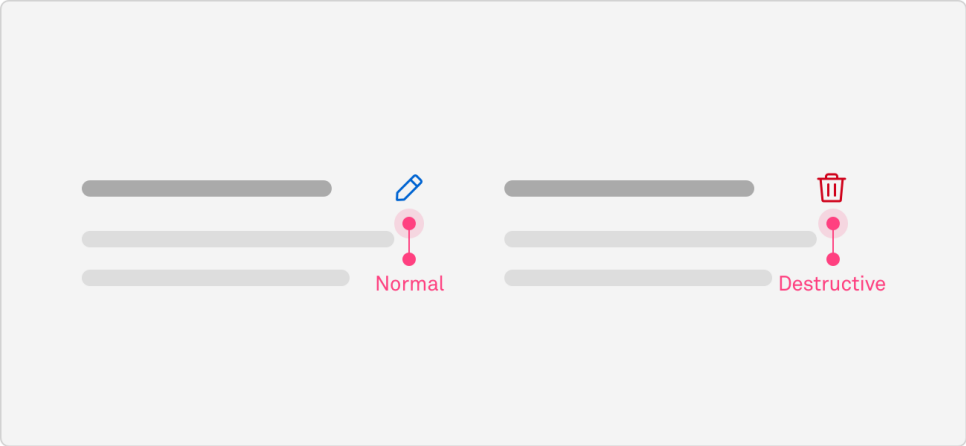
An Icon Button can be used for:

1. Performing an inline action (add, search, edit, etc) within its context.
2. Screen navigation actions, such as:
   - Initiate a new flow or exit current flow
   - Show a bottom sheet or a contextual menu.
   - Close or dismiss a UI element (dialogues, cards, banner, notifications).
   - Allow users to navigate backwards or forwards.

Keep in mind, Icon Buttons shouldn't be used in global navigation bars on native platforms. Android & iOS have dedicated component to be used in those UI controls.

- iOS uses UIBarItem in Navigation Bars, Tab Bars and Toolbars.
- Android uses Menu Item in Action Bars and Bottom Navigation.

Identify Your Action Type



To help users to make decisions in their journey, it's important not to use an interactive blue colour to perform a destructive action.

Using the destructive red colour for destructive action not only provides a strong visual cue for warnings, but it can also help warn users they are about to commit an action that may result in loss of data.

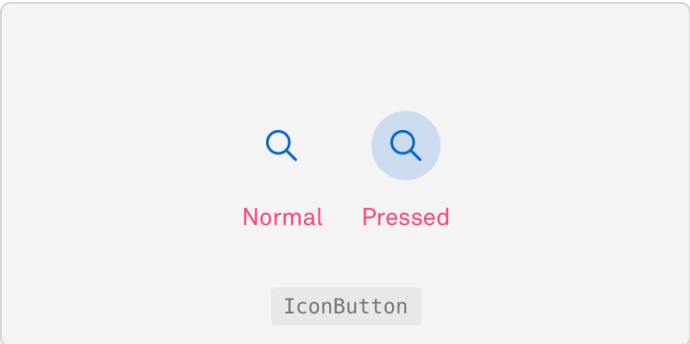
For more guidance on which action is considered destructive, see Understanding Normal & Destructive Actions - v2.

Variants

There are 2 variants of the Icon Buttons:

1. Icon Button
2. Icon Button Destructive

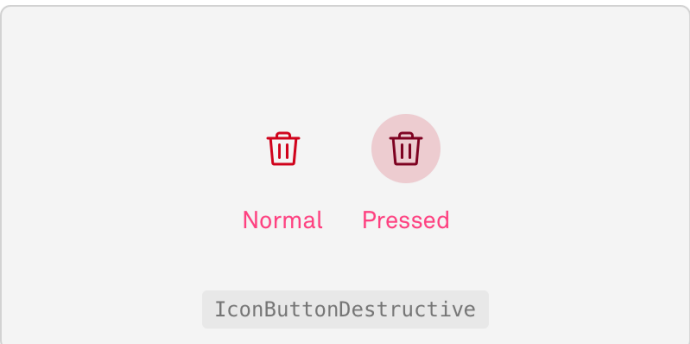
Icon Button (Default)



This is the default style for Icon Button.

- Use it to perform an inline action (such as add or edit) with its content.
- Use it for screen navigation actions, such as closing a modal dialogue.
- The action should never be the primary action of the page.

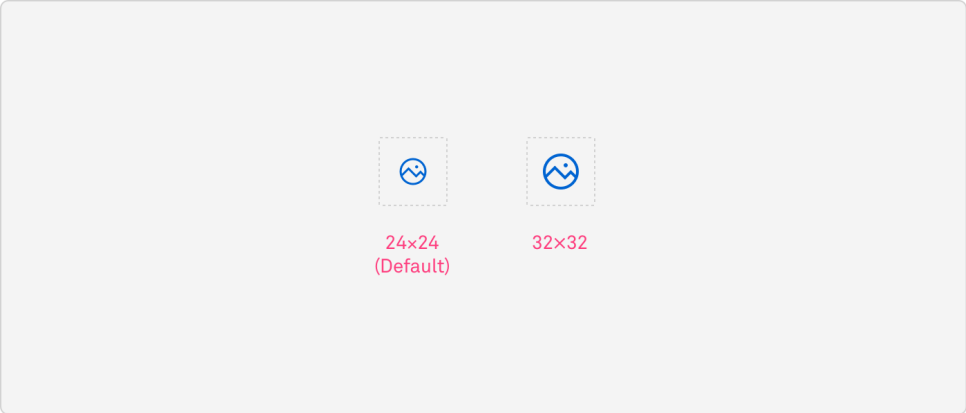
Icon Button Destructive



This is the destructive style for Icon Button.

- Use this style to prompt users before committing a destructive action.
- Depended on the user flow, you may want to consider prompting the users to confirm the destructive action with a confirmation modal or UI.

Icon Sizes

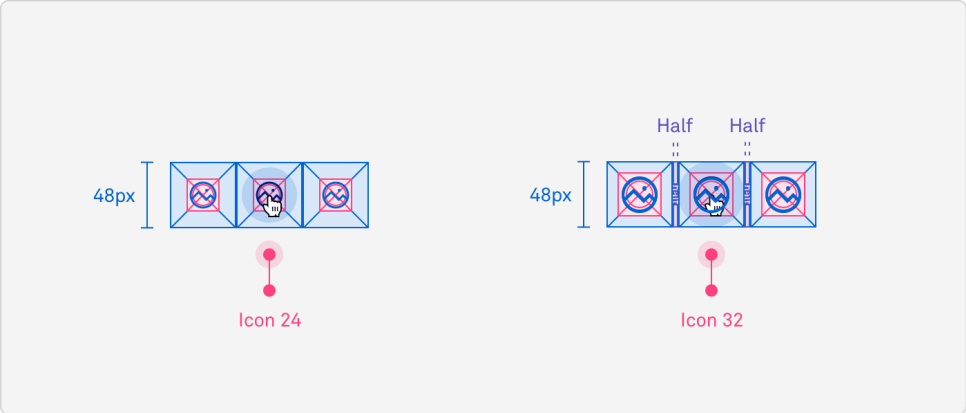


Icon Buttons are available in 2 sizes:

- 24 x 24 - (Default size)
- 32 x 32

Designers have the flexibility to choose the size appropriate to the space available.

Button Grouping

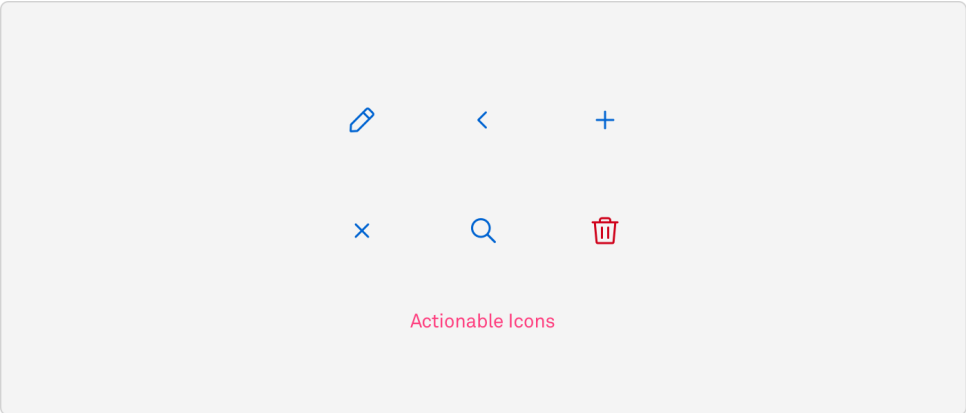


When you're grouping multiple Icon buttons at once, you can layout icon button horizontally.

Use **0** spacings between the buttons when grouping buttons with icon size 24.

Use **spacingHalf** between the buttons when grouping buttons with icon size 32.

Which Actionable Icons Can I Use?



Not all icons are suitable to be used standalone in our icon library.

The research on icon usability indicated some icons without a text label may continue to be ambiguous to users. If an icon is not immediately clear to users, they may feel confused and frustrated, it may also hinders them from completing a task.

Therefore, to help designer pick the suitable icons, we put together a list of icons that can be used standalone to represent specific actions in Telstra's context.

Eligible Icons

For Normal Actions

Icon	Usage Recommendation

For Destructive Actions

Icon	Usage Recommendation

Icon	Usage Recommendation
+	Reserved for adding a new item or a value.
–	Reserved for subtracting a value. (Don't use for delete action)
	Reserved for entering an edit mode.
	Reserved for search related actions.
<	Reserved for going backward.
>	Reserved for going forward.
×	Reserved for closing a dialogue / a notification bar, dismissing a card or exiting a flow.
	Action related to downloading a file.
	Trigger a content refresh.
⋮ (Android only)	Show a dropdown menu.
··· (iOS & Web)	Show an action sheet / bottom sheet on iOS. Show a dropdown menu on Web.
	Mark an item as favourite.
	Unfavourite an item.
	Initiate an online or live chat conversion.
(Android & Web) (iOS only)	Send a text message in chat UI.
(Android only) (iOS only)	Show a list of sharing options.

Icon	Usage Recommendation
	Reserved for deleting or removing an item.

Best Practices (For Designers)

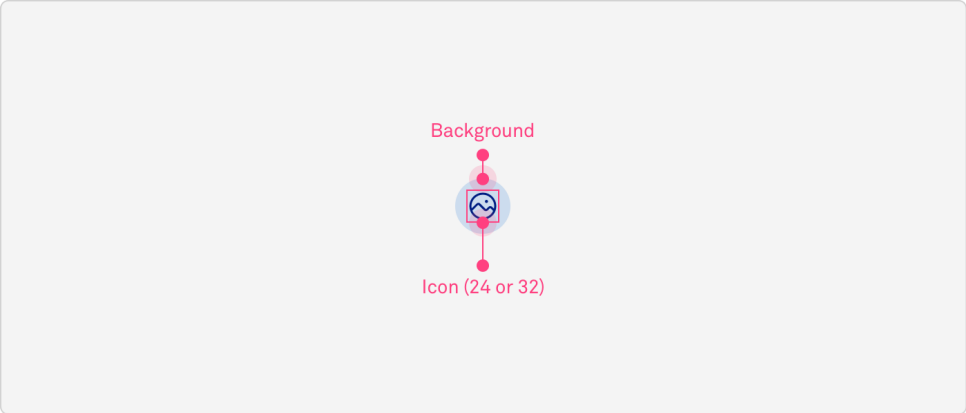
- **Only use Icon Buttons when standalone icons provide a clear action in its context.**
  The past research on icon usability has shown using a combination of icon and text label is more effective in clarifying its meaning than just using icon alone.
  If there's enough space, a low emphasis style Action Button is always a better button choice.
- **Not all icons are suitable to be used in icon buttons.**
  Don't use Status icons in icon buttons as they're designed to convey an outcome of a particular task, not to support performing an action. For icon choices, see our recommendation on actionable icons.
- **Identify whether the button's action is Normal or Destructive.**
  Identify the correct action type can help communicate the purpose more effectively. Learn more on how to differentiate Normal and Destructive action.
- **Only group icon buttons of same icon size.**
  When you're grouping multiple icon buttons together, be sure icon size are the same and follow the recommended spacing between them.
- **Must provide an accessible text label for each Icon Button.**
  The accessible text label should clearly describes button's action to assistive technology.
- **Icon Button should have a minimum touch target of 48 x 48 across Android / iOS and Web.**
  The components are built with a minimum touch size of 48 x 48. Do not modify this settings, as it would hinder user's interaction experience.

Best Practices (For Developers)

- **Icon buttons should be implemented as a button element, not as a link element on Web.**
- **An accessibility text label must be provided for each icon button.**
- **Icon Button should not be used in global navigation bars on Android or iOS.**
  Android & iOS have dedicated component to be used in those UI controls. iOS should use UIBarItem in Navigation Bars, Tab Bars and Toolbars. Android should use Menu Item in Action Bars and Bottom Navigation.

For full web development guidance, see Icon Button Developer Documentation.

Anatomy



Interactions

An Icon Button can be activated:

- on mouse click (on Web)
- with a single tap (on touch-up on iOS / on click on Android)

It can also be activated with a keyboard using SPACEBAR or ENTER key on all platforms.

Supported States

Due to the nature of platform behaviour, Web and native platforms have a different number of interaction states. To understand the interaction states in full detail, see Interaction States.

States	UI Preview	Web (Visual Preview)	Android (Visual Preview)	iOS (Visual Preview)
Normal		✅	✅	✅
Hover (Web only)		✅	🚫 Not supported	🚫 Not supported
Pressed		✅	✅	✅
Disabled		🚫 Not supported	✅	✅
Keyboard Focused ⌨️		✅	🚧 Not supported yet	🚧 Not supported yet
Screen Reader Focused 🗣️		(System default)	(System default)	(System default)

Accessibility Considerations

Icon Buttons are designed to meet the WCAG 2.1 Success Criteria outlined below. All requirements should be considered and understood when using the pattern. Requirements marked with ⚠️ indicate partial compliance or compliance must be met in build.

General

- 1.1.1 Non-text Content (A) - All Icon Buttons must contain an accessible text alternative that describes the purpose of the button to assistive technology. Do not add the word 'button' in the label.
  ⚠️ This requirement must be met by a content specialist or producer when authoring.
- 3.3.2 Labels or Instructions (A) - An Icon Button can be used to label a field if it meets certain requirements both in the design (visually) and in the code - this is listed as a technique within the standards. An example of usage would be a search field and search icon button adjacent to the field.
  ⚠️ Requirement must be met when in use.

Design & Development

- 1.4.10 Reflow (AA) - When scaled to 400%, there is no loss of content or functionality

- 1.4.11 Non Text Contrast (AA) - The visual indicators of the Icon Button meet the 3:1 contrast ratio in all states supported (disabled state is exempt from this as listed in the standards)
- 2.1.1 Keyboard (A) - Icon Buttons are accessible by keyboard
- 2.4.3 Focus Order (A) - Icon Buttons receive focus and should be present in a meaningful focus order sequence.
  ⚠️ Partial requirement met - ensure logical order when in use
- 2.4.7 Focus Visible (AA) - Icon Buttons have a visible focus state.
- 2.5.5 Target Size (AAA) - Icon Buttons have a minimum 48x48 touch target in Web/Android/iOS.
- 4.1.2 Name, Role, Value (A) - Icon Buttons have a name and role can be programmatically determined; The role is implicit if using the native element.

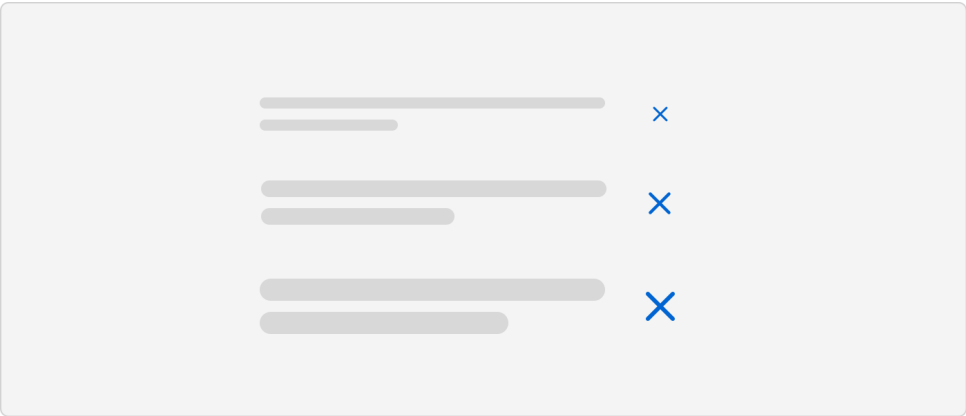
Keyboard

Refer to keyboard accessibility for Action Buttons.

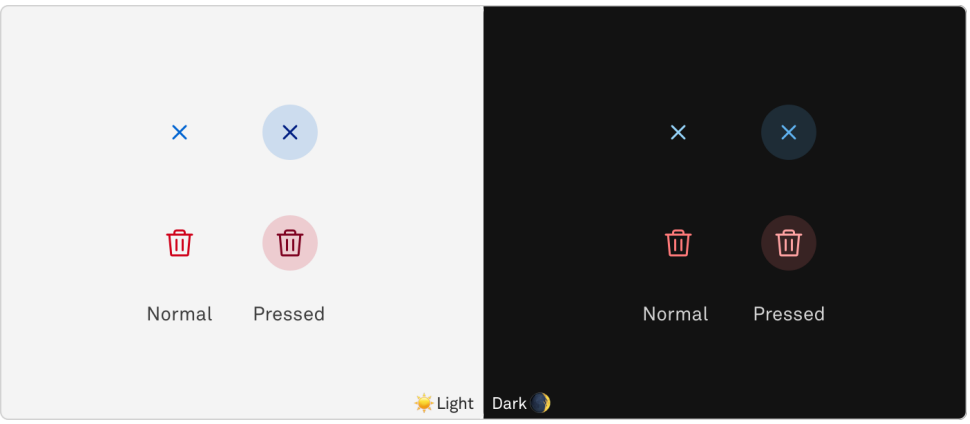
Screenreader

Refer to screen reader accessibility for Action Buttons.

Capabilities



Icon Buttons are scaled automatically based on the user's text size preferences.



Icon Buttons will automatically update their appearance based on user's light or dark appearance settings.

Related Patterns

- Action Button
- Icons

No labels

Atlassian